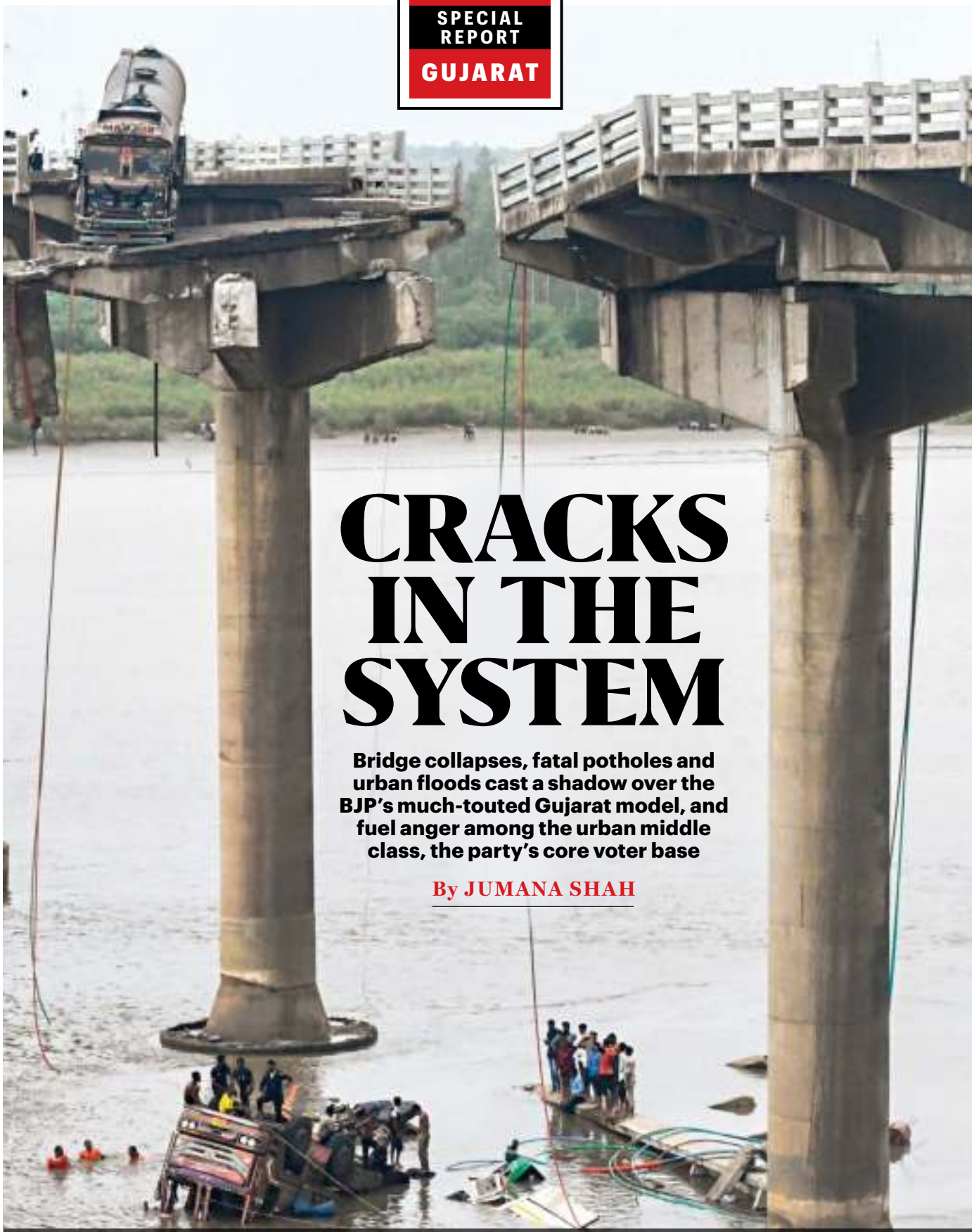
SPECIAL REPORT
GUJARAT



CRACKS IN THE SYSTEM

Bridge collapses, fatal potholes and urban floods cast a shadow over the BJP's much-touted Gujarat model, and fuel anger among the urban middle class, the party's core voter base

By JUMANA SHAH

PTI

GAMBHIRA BRIDGE, Vadodara , July 9
The 40-year-old bridge connecting Vadodara and Anand districts collapsed when a 10-15-metre slab gave way, causing several vehicles to plunge into the Mahisagar river. The bridge was known to be in poor condition despite "some repairs"; prior warnings had been ignored

20 DEATHS

9 INJURED

THE REASONS
A preliminary investigation by the roads and buildings department pointed to structural failure due to 'pedestal and articulation crushing'. Heavy rains may have contributed